

Elizabeth Burland

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ACADEMIC AND RESEARCH POSITIONS

Harvard University	
Associate Director of Research, Center for Education Policy Research	2026-present
University of Connecticut	
Assistant Research Professor, School of Public Policy	2023-2026
Affiliate, Center for Connecticut Education Research Collaboration	2023-2026
Research Affiliations	
Affiliate, Education Policy Initiative, University of Michigan	2023-present
Affiliate, Poverty and Inequality Research Lab, Johns Hopkins University	2019-present

EDUCATION

University of Michigan, Gerald R. Ford School of Public Policy	
Ph.D. in Public Policy and Sociology	2023
Causal Inference in Education Policy Research Predoctoral Fellowship program (IES Funded)	2023
University of Delaware, School of Public Policy and Administration	
M.A. in Urban Affairs and Public Policy	2015
B.A. (Honors) in Public Policy, University of Delaware	2015

PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 **Elizabeth Burland**, Jasmina Camo-Biogradlija, Kelcie Ferrara-Gerson, Xavier Fields, Katherine Micheltmore, Nathan Sotherland, Kevin Stange, Marissa Thompson, and Megan Tompkins-Stange. “Bureaucracy and Burden: Understanding Take-up of a Need-Based Financial Aid Program.” (Forthcoming). *American Educational Research Journal*. [[Link to working paper](#)].
- 2023 **Elizabeth Burland**, Susan Dynarski, Katherine Micheltmore, Stephanie Owen, and Shwetha Raghuraman. “The Power of Certainty: Experimental Evidence on the Effective Design of “Free Tuition” Programs.” *American Economic Review: Insights*. [[Link to published paper](#)]
- 2019 **Elizabeth Burland**. “Wealth and Well-Being in the United States.” Pp. 221–45 in *Wealth(s) and Subjective Well-Being*. Vol. 76, Social Indicators Research. Springer, Cham.

WORKING PAPERS & MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

- 2026 **Elizabeth Burland**, Nora Delaney, Susan Dynarski, Katherine Leu, CJ Libassi, Katherine Micheltmore, Stephanie Owen, Mary Quiroga, Elizabeth Salinas. “A Pathway to Mobility: Shifting Low-Income Students to Higher-Quality Degrees.” *Under review*.
Also available as NBER Working Paper No. 35434 [[Link to working paper](#)].
- Elizabeth Burland**. “Following in Their Footsteps or Avoiding Their Mistakes? The Role of Older Siblings in Shaping Access to Educational Opportunity.” *Under review*.
- Elizabeth Burland** and Stefanie DeLuca. “‘With Little Consequence’: Risk, Financial Aid and the Postsecondary Decisions of Low-income Students.”

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Elizabeth Burland, Jasmina Camo-Biogradlija, Xavier Fields, and Nathan Sotherland. “‘It was Trial by Fire’: How school counselors respond to ambiguous advising expectations.”

Elizabeth Burland and Jasmina Camo- Biogradlija. “Diverging Perceptions of Family Support: Comparative Evidence of Parent and Students Differences in the Experience of Educational Decision-Making.”

Elizabeth Burland. “Varying Contexts, Varying Consequences: The Role of Geographic Variation in Shaping Educational Inequality.”

POLICY BRIEFS AND REPORTS

2026 **Elizabeth Burland**, Jasmina Camo-Biogradlija, Xavier Fields, Megan Tompkins-Stange, and Jessica Vivar. “Michigan’s Tuition Incentive Program: Understanding Take-Up.” [Policy Brief]. *Education Policy Initiative, University of Michigan*.
[\[Link to policy brief\]](#)

2026 Jinhai Yu, **Elizabeth Burland**, Eric Brunner, Jinsoon Cho, Vanessa Reineke. “Categorizing and Understanding Facilities and Long-term (Capital) Investments.” [Report]. *Center for Connecticut Education Research Collaboration*.
[\[Link to full report\]](#).

GRANTS AND AWARDS

External Grants and Fellowships

- 2025-2028 Arnold Ventures grant, for: “Experimental Evidence of the Effect on Low-Income Students of a Four-Year Tuition Guarantee.” Co-Principal Investigator, with Susan Dynarski and Stephanie Owen (\$ 564,061).
- 2023-2025 Russell Sage Foundation grant, for: “How Do High-Achieving Low-Income Students Make Postsecondary Decisions? Identifying Mechanisms and Understanding Heterogeneity in the HAIL Financial Aid Intervention.” Co-Principal Investigator, with Stefanie DeLuca (\$182,867).
- 2022-2027 Institute of Education Sciences grant, for “Early First-Dollar Categorical Need-Based Aid: A New Model for Making College Affordable?” (\$2,702,034).

University of Michigan Grants and Fellowships

- 2022 Robert Kahn Fellowship for the Scientific Study of Social Issues, Institute for Social Research, University of Michigan (\$25,000).
- 2022 Doctoral Graduate Student Research Assistant Funding Competition: Research on Strategies to Prevent and Alleviate Poverty, Poverty Solutions, University of Michigan. (\$11,598, *declined award*)
- 2017-2021 Institute of Education Sciences Predoctoral Training Fellowship
- 2020 Weinberg Graduate Student Award, University of Michigan Population Studies Center (\$4,000).
- 2020 Sarri Family Foundation Fellowship, University of Michigan Center for Political Studies (\$6,000).

TEACHING AND MENTORING EXPERIENCE

University of Connecticut

Teaching (as Instructor of Record)

- 2025-2026 Applied Research Design (MPA course | PP5370)

2023-2026 Higher Education Policy (MPP/MPA; Undergraduate course | PP5397/3098)

2024 Cases in Public Policy & Management (Undergraduate course | PP3020W)

2024 Introduction to Public Policy & Management (MPP/MPA course | PP5340)

Mentorship

2024-2026 Research Supervisor (2 graduate assistants), UConn School of Public Policy.

2024-2025 Advisor (12 students), UConn School of Public Policy, MPA and MPP Programs.

2021-2026 Research Supervisor (5 undergraduate, pre-doctoral, and doctoral research assistants annually), HAIL Qualitative Research Group, Poverty and Inequality Research Lab.

University of Michigan

Teaching (as Graduate Student Instructor)

2021 Evaluating Public Policies (Undergraduate course | PubPol479).

Guest Lecturer

2021, 2022 Causal Inference in Education Policy Research, Ford School of Public Policy (PubPol 712). Title: *Mixed Methods Research: Implementing a Qualitative Study within a Randomized, Controlled Trial*.

2021 Children and Youth Services and Social Policies, School of Social Work (SSW 633). Title: *Education Policy and Funding Higher Education*.

Mentorship

2021-2023 Training Lead, Qualitative Interview Methods and Qualitative Coding in MAXQDA.

2020-2023 Project Manager, Postsecondary Student Decision Making Study. (10 research assistants).

2019 Graduate Student Preliminary Exam Mentor, Department of Sociology. Subject area: Demography: Inequality, Family, Health and Aging, and Demographic Methods. (4 PhD students).

2019 Sociology Undergraduate Research Opportunity (SURO) supervisor. *Project*: “The Effects of Expanding Financial Aid: Higher Education Act Re-Authorization of 1992.” (1 research assistant)

University of Delaware

Teaching (as Teaching Assistant)

2015 Working and Learning in Washington, DC., Co-listed Department of Political Science and the School of Public Policy and Administration (POSC 483/UAPP 433/UAPP 733-010).

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

** Invited Talks*

2026 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Conference
Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference

2025 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Conference
American Sociological Association Annual Conference
Sociology of Education Annual Conference

2024 Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Conference

2023 University of Chicago*
University of Michigan Ed Policy Talks*
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Conference
American Sociological Association Annual Conference
Sociology of Education Annual Conference
Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference

2022	TransferBOOST Webinar hosted by HCM Strategists* National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER), Public Economics Program Meeting American Educational Research Association
2021	Michigan State University* Population Association of America Annual Conference Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference
2020	Population Association of America Annual Conference (<i>scheduled, conference cancelled</i>)
2021	Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND ACTIVITIES

Public Scholarship and Service to the Community

- Panelist at the Hartford Foundation’s giving circle. Panel title: “Understanding the Landscape of Post-Secondary Success in 2025.”
- Presentation at the Michigan College Access Network (MCAN) Annual College Access Process. Title: “Take-Up and Take-Aways from the Tuition Incentive Project Evaluation” (2024).

Service to the Profession

- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (Annual conference submission peer review, 2025)
- Association for Education Finance and Policy (Annual conference submission peer review, 2025)
- Occasional journal reviewer: American Economic Review: Insights; Social Forces; Education Finance and Policy; Higher Education; American Economic Journal: Economic Policy.
- Section on Inequality, Poverty, and Mobility (Communications Committee 2018-2019)
- Section on Sociology of Education (Newsletter Editor, August 2018)

University of Connecticut Service

- UConn IDEA Grant Program (Student Grant Reviewer, 2025)
- Research Seminar Committee Member, School of Public Policy (Summer 2024-present)
- School of Public Policy Awards Committee Member (2024-2025)
- MPA Fellows Curriculum Committee Member (2024-2025)
- Research Faculty Search Committee Member, School of Public Policy (Summer 2024)
- MPP Committee Member, School of Public Policy (Summer 2024-present)

University of Michigan Service

- Education Policy Initiative Antiracism Working Group (Participant 2020-2023)
- Ford School of Public Policy, Ph.D. Admissions Committee (Committee member 2017-2019, 2022)
- Causal Inference in Education Research Seminar Climate & Inclusion Working Group (2019-2023)
- Virtual Inequality Brownbag, Center for Inequality Dynamics (Organizing Committee 2021)
- Causal Inference in Education Research Seminar (Co-coordinator 2019-2021)
- Sociology Department Graduate Student Recruitment Coordinator (2020-2021)
- Inequality, Demography and Family Workshop (Co-coordinator 2018-2019)

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Institute for Public Administration, University of Delaware

Administrative Coordinator, Wilmington Education Improvement Commission January 2015- August 2016

- Coordinated research and administrative support for commission and community-led subcommittees (for WEIC and its predecessor, the Wilmington Education Advisory Committee).
- Delivered solutions to community-identified problems through written and oral communication.

- Oversaw development of legislative policy change.
- Supervised five undergraduate and graduate-level research assistants.

Washington, DC Experience, Program Coordinator

August 2014-January 2015

- Coordinated and supervised 20 undergraduate students in Washington, DC internships.
- Arranged lectures and 4 guest speaker visits to support student learning.
- Developed an alumni networking program to facilitate network development and student career goals.

Delaware General Assembly

Legislative Fellow

January 2014-June 2014

- Generated research-driven answers for key policy stakeholders to support constituent relations and legislative decision-making.
- Facilitated productive discussions among policy actors and inclusion of community voices.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management
- Association for Education Finance and Policy
- American Sociological Association
- Sociology of Education Association